

EU Green Claims Review Kit

A documented review file per claim with evidence links, risk scores, remediation across every instance, and signed review records ready for counsel verification.

Galaxy Forge Implementation Kit | Version 1.0 | September 2026

Companion files: Excel workbook, editable Word templates, README.

Green Claims Review Kit Guide. Slug `empco_green_claims_kit`. Price \$69. Version 1.0. This guide helps direct-to-consumer, e-commerce, fashion, and cosmetics brands that market environmental claims to consumers in the European Union to inventory every claim, link each claim to evidence, score risk under the Empowering Consumers rules applicable from 27 September 2026, remediate high-risk claims, and document review decisions. From that date, generic claims such as eco-friendly, green, or climate neutral, sustainability labels not based on certification schemes or established by public authorities, claims that present a part as the whole, and offset-based carbon-neutral product claims are prohibited in the sense defined by the official text. This guide is general information and is not legal advice. Re-verify requirements with official sources and counsel before publishing or retaining any claim. It does not promise any enforcement outcome.

Dated enforcement landscape, September 2026. The rules applied from 27 September 2026, but transposition is a national patchwork: the Commission opened infringement procedures against 20 member states for late transposition, so enforcement pace differs by market. Belgium transposed with civil and criminal enforcement available from day one (fines up to 10 percent of turnover in serious cases) alongside a six-month administrative grace period to 27 March 2027. Germany applies greenwashing rules to business-to-business practices as well, unlike the consumer-only baseline elsewhere. Brand and company names, plus imagery and colour schemes, can themselves count as environmental claims. Old stock may benefit from phased enforcement only where businesses face genuine transitional difficulties and are taking reasonable compliance steps. The separate Green Claims substantiation proposal was shelved in 2025. Recheck your markets before every consequential decision, because this landscape is moving.

How to use this kit. The kit contains this guide, a workbook with five sheets, and three document templates. Start by copying every consumer-facing environmental statement from your website, product pages, packaging, advertising, social posts, influencer briefs, checkout pages, and customer emails into the Claim Inventory sheet. Then open the Evidence File Log and link each claim to the test report, certificate, data set, or calculation that supports it. Next run the Risk Scorer to rank each claim

by generic wording, substantiation strength, label basis, whole-versus-part scope, and offset reliance. Move high-risk items into the Remediation Tracker with an owner and a due date. Record the final retain, reword, or remove decision and its rationale in the Review Worksheet. Have counsel verify the plan before you republish.

Background in plain language. The Empowering Consumers Directive amends unfair commercial practices law to address vague and misleading environmental claims. Its core idea is simple: consumers should see specific, substantiated, and verifiable claims, not broad impressions of sustainability. To deliver that, the directive prohibits certain practices outright, meaning they are unfair in all circumstances without a case-by-case assessment of consumer impact, and it strengthens the general prohibition on misleading actions and omissions for the remaining claims. Member states transpose the directive into national law, and enforcement sits with national authorities and courts. Because transposition details, guidance, and related instruments such as the proposed green-claims substantiation framework continue to develop, always confirm the current applicable national rules with official sources and counsel.

What is banned in the per se sense. Four groups matter most for daily marketing work. First, generic environmental claims without recognized excellent environmental performance or clear specification in immediate proximity, such as eco-friendly, green, sustainable, or climate friendly stated alone. Second, sustainability labels that are not based on certification schemes with transparent criteria and independent verification, or that were not established by public authorities, including many self-created badges and icons. Third, claims that present a legal requirement as a distinctive feature, or that present the environmental benefit of one component as a benefit of the whole product or business. Fourth, carbon-neutral, climate-neutral, or equivalent product claims based on offsetting greenhouse gas emissions outside the value chain. Each group is assessed on the exact wording, placement, imagery, and overall impression seen by the consumer.

What remains allowed when done correctly. Specific, substantiated claims can still be used. A claim that states the exact attribute, the exact scope, the measurement basis, and the time period, placed close to the claim, linked to accessible supporting information, and consistent with the full product life cycle, follows the direction the law favors. Examples of the pattern, each labeled illustrative, include stating recycled content with percentage, scope, standard, and verification; stating reduced packaging weight with baseline year and measurement scope; or stating reparability with the scoring method and model coverage. Certification marks from credible independent schemes can support communication when their criteria genuinely cover the claimed attribute and when use follows the scheme rules. The workbook helps you test each claim against this pattern rather than relying on impression.

Method overview in five phases. Phase 1 Inventory takes one to two weeks and produces a complete Claim Inventory across all channels. Phase 2 Evidence Linking takes two to four weeks and produces an Evidence File Log where every claim has either a linked exhibit or an explicit gap. Phase 3 Risk Scoring takes one week and produces a scored list with high-risk items flagged for action. Phase 4 Remediation takes two to six weeks and produces revised copy, new substantiation, or removals with before-and-after records. Phase 5 Review and Maintenance produces signed Review Worksheets, a publication checklist, and a quarterly monitoring routine. Marketing, product, legal, and e-commerce functions all participate, because claims live in copy, artwork, product data, and media buys simultaneously.

Workflow 1 claim inventory. Step 1 define the capture scope: home page, category pages, product detail pages, cart and checkout, packaging and inserts, paid search and social copy, organic social posts and reels, influencer briefs and gifted-post requirements, marketplace listings, press releases, and customer-service macros. Step 2 copy the exact wording, note the channel, capture the URL or artwork reference and the date observed, and record the owner. Step 3 flag visual cues such as leaves, globes, green color blocks, and badge-like icons, because imagery can create a claim even when words are careful. Step 4 include claims in all languages you publish. Step 5 freeze the inventory with a version date. Illustrative example, labeled illustrative: a fashion brand captures forty-two statements, finding that three product pages, one checkout banner, and two influencer briefs repeat the same generic phrase with different punctuation.

Workflow 2 evidence file log. For each inventoried claim, record the attribute claimed, the scope such as product, component, packaging, or company, the substantiation type such as test report, life-cycle study, certificate, metered data, or supplier declaration, the exhibit reference and date, the issuer and independence status, the coverage match between what was tested and what is claimed, and the expiry or review date. Mark each link as direct, partial, or missing. A life-cycle study for one fabric does not directly support a whole-garment claim. A 2021 energy bill does not directly support a current carbon statement. Supplier declarations need a verification plan, not just a file. Illustrative example, labeled illustrative: a cosmetics brand links a recycled-plastic claim to a supplier certificate covering only caps, marking the bottle-body scope as missing and triggering a reword or new evidence task.

Workflow 3 risk scorer. Score each claim on five factors with one to three points each. Factor 1 generic wording: specific wording scores one, qualified wording scores two, standalone generic wording scores three. Factor 2 substantiation: current direct independent evidence scores one, dated or partial evidence scores two, no evidence scores three. Factor 3 label basis: public-authority or credible certified scheme use scores one, third-party scheme with unclear coverage scores two, own badge without independent scheme scores three. Factor 4 scope honesty: whole matches tested scope scores one, ambiguous scope scores two, part presented as whole scores three. Factor 5 offset reliance: no offset-based neutrality claim scores one, footprint reduction with separate offset disclosure scores two, offset-based neutral claim scores three. Sum the factors. Totals of twelve or above require action before further publication. Calibrate thresholds with counsel.

Workflow 4 remediation tracker. For each claim scoring twelve or above, or flagged by counsel regardless of score, choose retain with new evidence, reword to specific language, relocate context closer to the claim, add accessible supporting information, replace an own badge with compliant text or a qualifying scheme, or remove the claim from all instances. Record the decision, the new wording, the evidence added, the owner, the due date, and the verification date when the live channel was re-checked. Track every instance separately, because fixing a product page while leaving the same phrase in paid search still leaves exposure. Illustrative example, labeled illustrative: a brand replaces a standalone climate-neutral badge with a factual statement about measured reductions, scope, baseline year, and a separate note about any offset purchases kept outside the product claim.

Workflow 5 review worksheet. Close each claim with a one-page style record: claim text, channel, score, evidence references, applicable legal basis considered, decision of retain, reword, or remove, new wording where relevant, reviewer functions, counsel verification date, publication date, and next review date. Keep before-and-after screenshots or artwork exports with dates. File the worksheet with the evidence exhibits so a future reviewer can reconstruct the decision in minutes. Review repeat

claims quarterly, seasonal campaigns before launch, and influencer content before posting. Illustrative example, labeled illustrative: a home-care brand records that a refill claim was reworded from a generic green phrase to a specific packaging-weight statement with baseline year and verification reference.

Copy patterns that reduce risk. Favor nouns and numbers over adjectives. State the attribute, the number, the scope, the method or standard, and the date. Place the specification immediately next to the claim, not three clicks away. Keep imagery consistent with words: do not pair a narrow recycled-cap fact with a forest image that suggests broader benefit. Avoid comparisons without a stated baseline, such as cleaner or greener without versus-what and measured-how. Avoid legal-requirement claims such as noting compliance with a mandatory substance restriction as if it were a brand advantage. Keep translations equivalent across languages, because a careful English page paired with a broad translated page still leaves the broad version exposed.

Handling labels, badges, and icons. List every mark that looks like an endorsement, including leaves, checkmarks in circles, green stars, and terms such as certified, verified, or approved. For each mark, record the scheme owner, the public standard or criteria document, the certification scope and certificate number, the audit or verification date, and the usage rules. Retire own badges that lack an independent scheme or public-authority basis. Where a credible scheme genuinely covers the attribute, use the scheme mark exactly as licensed and keep the certificate current. Where no scheme fits, replace the badge with plain specific text plus accessible supporting information. Illustrative example, labeled illustrative: a footwear brand retires two own icons and keeps one independent materials certificate, rewording surrounding copy to match the certificate scope exactly.

Handling carbon and climate language with care. Product-level neutral or net-zero claims based on offsets outside the value chain belong in the remove-or-fundamentally-rewrite group under the per se prohibition. Separate three things that marketing often merges: measured footprint reductions inside the value chain, high-quality information about offsets or contributions outside the value chain, and any suggestion that the product itself has no climate impact. Only the first can support a product attribute claim, and only when specific and substantiated. If the business purchases credits, describe that purchase as a separate contribution with project, standard, vintage, and retirement detail, away from product-attribute language, and only after counsel review. Never imply that buying credits erases the product footprint.

Influencers, affiliates, and marketplaces. Claims made on your behalf count. Review influencer briefs, gifting notes, affiliate copy blocks, and marketplace attribute fields with the same inventory discipline as your own site. Prohibit generic phrases and own badges in briefs, supply approved specific sentences, require pre-publication review of posts, and keep dated copies of what was published. For marketplaces, check auto-generated badges and filter attributes that may attach environmental labels to your listings without your input. Correct errors through the platform process and keep the correspondence. Illustrative example, labeled illustrative: a cosmetics brand finds that an affiliate template repeats an old generic phrase, replaces the template, asks partners to update live posts by a fixed date, and logs completion per partner.

Packaging, inserts, and retail touchpoints. Packaging persists long after a website fix, so treat it as a separate remediation stream with print deadlines and stock-use planning. Inventory front-of-pack claims, back-of-pack paragraphs, hang tags, box interiors, inserts, and QR-linked pages. Align on-pack wording with the same evidence file used online. Where old stock carries retired claims, seek counsel advice on handling, stickers, or withdrawal rather than improvising. Plan artwork revisions with the

same review worksheet and counsel verification as digital copy. Illustrative example, labeled illustrative: a fashion label schedules a packaging rerun that replaces a generic hang-tag phrase with fiber-content-specific text and a scheme reference that matches the certificate scope.

Roles, training, and internal controls. Assign four functions in writing: a claims owner in marketing who maintains the inventory, an evidence owner in product or sustainability who maintains the log, a channel owner in e-commerce and design who implements changes across instances, and a reviewer plus counsel who verify decisions. Train copywriters, designers, buyers, and customer-service staff on the four prohibited groups, the specific-claim pattern, and the escalation path. Keep a training log by function and date. Require a completed review worksheet before any new environmental claim goes live. Review agency and freelancer contracts so that claim compliance duties and pre-publication approval rights are explicit rather than assumed.

Checklist A inventory completeness. One, all websites and locales listed. Two, product pages sampled by category. Three, cart and checkout reviewed. Four, packaging and inserts captured. Five, paid and organic social captured. Six, influencer briefs and posts captured. Seven, marketplace listings captured. Eight, press and service macros captured. Nine, imagery and icons flagged. Ten, inventory version dated and owned. Checklist B evidence quality. One, attribute and scope stated. Two, exhibit linked per claim. Three, issuer and independence recorded. Four, coverage match assessed. Five, dates and expiry checked. Six, translations aligned. Seven, gaps marked missing, not assumed. Eight, verification plan for declarations set. Nine, exhibits filed retrievably. Ten, next review date set.

Checklist C publication readiness. One, no standalone generic wording remains. Two, no own badge without scheme basis remains. Three, no part-for-whole presentation remains. Four, no offset-based product neutrality claim remains. Five, specifications sit adjacent to claims. Six, supporting information is accessible. Seven, imagery matches words. Eight, comparisons state baselines. Nine, translations are equivalent. Ten, counsel verification recorded. Eleven, before-and-after records filed. Twelve, monitoring owner assigned. Checklist D campaign launch. One, brief prohibits banned patterns. Two, approved sentences supplied. Three, artwork reviewed. Four, landing pages reviewed. Five, tracking parameters do not inject claims. Six, influencer posts pre-approved. Seven, marketplace attributes checked. Eight, service macros updated. Nine, launch worksheet signed. Ten, post-launch spot check scheduled.

Illustrative examples, all labeled illustrative. Example 1, illustrative: an apparel brand finds eco-friendly on twelve pages without specification, rewords eleven to fiber-specific recycled-content statements with percentages and standards, and removes one where no evidence exists. Example 2, illustrative: a cosmetics brand retires an own green-leaf badge, keeps one independent certification mark within its licensed scope, and adds a methods page linked from product pages. Example 3, illustrative: a home-goods seller corrects a part-for-whole claim by narrowing recyclable language from the whole product to the glass component actually covered by evidence. Example 4, illustrative: a footwear brand removes a carbon-neutral product badge based on offsets and publishes a factual reductions statement with scope, baseline year, and separate contribution disclosure after counsel review.

More illustrative examples, all labeled illustrative. Example 5, illustrative: a fashion marketplace seller discovers a platform filter labels its items sustainable without brand input, contacts platform support, corrects attribute data, and logs the exchange. Example 6, illustrative: a skincare brand aligns five language versions of a refill claim to the same specific wording, percentage basis, and verification reference. Example 7, illustrative: a furniture seller replaces a broad planet-safe banner with a

timber-sourcing statement tied to certificate scope and chain-of-custody coverage. Example 8, illustrative: a toy brand trains customer-service staff to use approved specific sentences instead of improvising broad green assurances in chat replies, and updates macros accordingly.

Frequently asked questions. One, does this kit make my claims lawful. No. It organizes inventory, evidence, and review. Only the exact wording, context, evidence, and applicable national rules determine the position, and counsel should verify difficult cases. Two, can I keep eco-friendly with a footnote. Standalone generic wording is the core per se risk; adding distant explanation does not cure it. Reword to specific language. Three, what about claims already live. Inventory them first, score them, remediate high-risk items promptly, and record decisions; do not wait for a campaign relaunch. Four, do influencer posts count. Yes. Brief, approve, and archive them like your own channels. Five, what if evidence is partial. Mark it partial, narrow the claim to the proven scope, or remove until evidence is complete.

More frequently asked questions. Six, can I compare against competitors. Comparisons need a stated baseline, identical scope, verifiable method, and current data; otherwise remove or reword. Seven, can I use a supplier declaration alone. Only with a verification plan, date, scope match, and renewal trigger; otherwise treat as partial. Eight, what about packaging already printed. Treat as a separate stream with counsel advice on stock handling and reprint timing. Nine, how often should I re-review. Quarterly for evergreen claims, before every campaign, and whenever evidence expires, products reformulate, or guidance changes. Ten, what records should I keep. Inventory versions, evidence exhibits, scores, worksheets, counsel notes, before-and-after captures, and publication logs. Eleven, who approves new claims. A named reviewer plus counsel verification before publication, without exception.

Further frequently asked questions. Twelve, are images really claims. Imagery contributes to overall impression and can support a misleading finding even when words are narrow; review visuals with the same care as copy. Thirteen, can a certification solve everything. Only when the scheme criteria genuinely cover the claimed attribute, verification is independent and current, and use follows scheme rules. Fourteen, what about legal-requirement claims. Presenting a mandatory feature as distinctive is separately prohibited; remove such framing. Fifteen, how do I handle translations. Approve each language version against the same evidence and scoring, not by machine-converting the headline. Sixteen, what if a marketplace adds a badge automatically. Correct the data, contact the platform, keep records, and re-check after catalog updates.

Limitations. This kit provides process tools, not legal advice. It does not interpret the law for your facts, does not certify claims, does not validate test reports or certificates, does not assess life-cycle studies, and does not clear copy for publication. It cannot create missing evidence, cannot fix reformulation needs, cannot control platform-generated badges beyond documented correction requests, and cannot remove risk from claims left live during remediation. National transposition, guidance, and enforcement practice may change. You must re-verify with official sources and qualified counsel. Never promise management, partners, or customers a particular enforcement outcome. Use the Review Worksheet to state plainly what remains unverified for each claim.

Disclosure and responsible use. The author of this kit has no access to your products, tests, or marketing accounts and makes no representation about your claims. Illustrative examples in this guide are simplified teaching scenarios, labeled illustrative, and do not describe any real brand, product, or enforcement matter. Brief numbers such as counts of statements in examples and the \$69 kit price are stated for orientation only. Do not copy evidence references between unrelated claims. Do not

backdate reviews or signatures. Do not keep a high-risk claim live while waiting for a convenient relaunch window. If you discover an error after publication, correct it promptly across all instances and record the correction with dates. Keep this guide version 1.0 with the review file so future reviewers know which procedure version you followed.

Implementation plan for a small team over six weeks. Week 1, assign functions, define channel scope, and start the Claim Inventory. Week 2, complete inventory across languages, freeze version one, and start linking exhibits in the Evidence File Log. Week 3, finish evidence linking, mark gaps explicitly, and run the Risk Scorer across all claims. Week 4, move high-risk items into the Remediation Tracker, draft reworded copy, and retire own badges. Week 5, verify new evidence, implement changes across every instance, capture before-and-after records, and complete Review Worksheets. Week 6, obtain counsel verification, publish corrected copy, brief influencers and service teams, and set quarterly monitoring with owners and dates. Keep a lessons log with one line per claim group and what slowed the file.

Common errors and how to avoid them. Error one, fixing the product page but leaving paid search and affiliates unchanged. Track every instance separately. Error two, adding a footnote far from a generic headline. Reword the headline itself. Error three, keeping an own badge for aesthetic reasons. Retire it unless an independent scheme or public-authority basis exists. Error four, stretching a component certificate to the whole product. Narrow the claim to the proven scope. Error five, relying on old tests after reformulation. Re-test or remove. Error six, translating headlines loosely. Approve each language. Error seven, letting influencers improvise. Supply approved sentences and require pre-approval. Error eight, delaying remediation until a relaunch. Act on high-risk items on a fixed timetable with counsel input.

Appendix A glossary. Generic claim means a broad environmental statement without clear specification in immediate proximity. Specific claim means a statement of the exact attribute, scope, basis, and period. Sustainability label means a voluntary trust mark suggesting environmental or social performance. Certification scheme means a documented set of criteria with transparent governance and independent verification. Part-for-whole means presenting a component benefit as a whole-product or whole-business benefit. Offset-based neutrality claim means a statement that a product has neutral impact because emissions were compensated outside the value chain. Review Worksheet means the one-page decision record used in this kit. Illustrative means a simplified teaching scenario, not a real case or a prediction of outcomes.

Appendix B retention index. Keep inventory versions with dates, evidence exhibits with issuer and date, coverage assessments, risk scores with thresholds used, remediation records with before-and-after captures, review worksheets with reviewer functions and counsel verification dates, publication logs with URLs and artwork references, influencer briefs and post archives, marketplace correction correspondence, training logs, and monitoring reports. Name files with claim identifier first, then channel, then date in year-month-day order. Store a read-only completed-review snapshot separate from working drafts. Verify backups quarterly by restoring one review set. Record the kit version used, which is 1.0, in each closed review so later teams know the procedure baseline.

Appendix C how to brief counsel efficiently. Prepare a one-page brief per claim group with the exact wording, screenshots or artwork, channel list, score, evidence exhibits, scope analysis, and the decision you propose. Attach the worksheet draft and the before-and-after copy where relevant. Ask narrow questions such as whether specific reworded copy is supportable on stated evidence, whether a particular scheme use matches its licensed scope, or whether a specific climate statement avoids

prohibited offset-based framing. Record counsel answers with date and scope, and file them with the review. Do not ask for blanket clearance across product lines. Allow time for at least one round of follow-up, because first answers often require additional exhibits you will need to gather from suppliers or labs.

Appendix D working with agencies and freelancers. Share the prohibited-groups summary, the specific-claim pattern, and three approved sentence models drawn from your own verified claims. Require that drafts arrive with evidence references and scope notes, not just headlines. Reserve a contractual right to approve environmental claims before publication and to require corrections on a fixed timetable. Review stock imagery and icon libraries for badge-like graphics that designers may insert without copy review. Keep a shared log of approved sentences by claim group so new team members reuse verified language instead of drafting fresh variants. Audit agency output quarterly against the inventory so drift is caught early.

Appendix E monitoring after go-live. Assign one owner to re-crawl priority pages, paid copy, social bios, packaging reprints, and marketplace attributes on a fixed monthly slot, plus a full quarterly inventory refresh. Log each check with date, scope, and findings. Trigger re-scoring whenever products reformulate, suppliers change, certificates expire, or guidance updates. Keep a change log at the front of the review file. This routine keeps the counsel-verify discipline alive after launch instead of letting claims drift back toward generic language under campaign pressure. When in doubt about a new headline, hold publication and seek counsel review on the specific wording and evidence rather than interpreting novel points alone.

Appendix F scaling from pilot to routine. After one full category pilot, standardize approved sentence models per claim group, pre-link recurring exhibits such as current certificates, and set service expectations such as evidence renewal thirty days before expiry. Create a weekly claims-review slot during campaign seasons, a monthly instance-completeness check, and a quarterly full refresh. Add new categories through the same pilot path, never directly into high-volume launch. Track cycle time from inventory to verified publication per claim group and investigate outliers. Keep a lessons log with one line per group, what slowed review, and what you changed. Steady routine matters more than any single tool, because consistent records across claims demonstrate a working system rather than a one-time effort.

Final review and sign-off. Before republishing corrected claims, confirm that the inventory covers all channels and languages, that every claim has either a linked exhibit or an explicit gap, that scores are complete, that high-risk items have tracked remediation across every instance, that worksheets are signed by function, that counsel verification is recorded with date and scope, and that before-and-after records are filed. Record this review in a short sign-off sheet with date and functions. Schedule the next review after the first month live, then quarterly. Keep this guide, the workbook version, and the template versions together with the sign-off so the basis of your process is traceable. Remember the standing rule: re-verify with official sources and counsel, because this area continues to develop. This guide is not legal advice and promises no outcome.

Operational drill, labeled illustrative: select one lot or one claim, run the full workbook path end to end with real file references, time each step, record friction points, and update the procedure with the fix before the next cycle. Keep the drill record with the lot or review file so progress is visible across weeks. Cycle 1 reinforces consistent file discipline, traceable decisions, and timely follow-up across suppliers, channels, and reviewers without adding new tools or changing assigned functions.

Documentation standard: write dates in year-month-day order, name files with identifiers first, cite exhibits by file name in every note, record reviewer function with each sign-off, and freeze submitted or published rows before starting amendments as new rows that reference the original. Cycle 2 reinforces consistent file discipline, traceable decisions, and timely follow-up across suppliers, channels, and reviewers without adding new tools or changing assigned functions.

Escalation rule: any missing core evidence, any supplier non-response past the agreed date, any uncertain scope decision, and any high-risk score moves to the Gap Memo or Remediation Tracker the same day with a named owner and a due date, plus a counsel question where the facts are difficult. Cycle 3 reinforces consistent file discipline, traceable decisions, and timely follow-up across suppliers, channels, and reviewers without adding new tools or changing assigned functions.

Quality check: a second function reviews scope decisions, evidence links, risk conclusions, and publication decisions before submission or republication, confirming that exhibits match the stated scope, dates are current, and open items are either closed or explicitly reviewed by counsel with written notes. Cycle 4 reinforces consistent file discipline, traceable decisions, and timely follow-up across suppliers, channels, and reviewers without adding new tools or changing assigned functions.

Operational drill, labeled illustrative: select one lot or one claim, run the full workbook path end to end with real file references, time each step, record friction points, and update the procedure with the fix before the next cycle. Keep the drill record with the lot or review file so progress is visible across weeks. Cycle 5 reinforces consistent file discipline, traceable decisions, and timely follow-up across suppliers, channels, and reviewers without adding new tools or changing assigned functions.

Documentation standard: write dates in year-month-day order, name files with identifiers first, cite exhibits by file name in every note, record reviewer function with each sign-off, and freeze submitted or published rows before starting amendments as new rows that reference the original. Cycle 6 reinforces consistent file discipline, traceable decisions, and timely follow-up across suppliers, channels, and reviewers without adding new tools or changing assigned functions.

Escalation rule: any missing core evidence, any supplier non-response past the agreed date, any uncertain scope decision, and any high-risk score moves to the Gap Memo or Remediation Tracker the same day with a named owner and a due date, plus a counsel question where the facts are difficult. Cycle 7 reinforces consistent file discipline, traceable decisions, and timely follow-up across suppliers, channels, and reviewers without adding new tools or changing assigned functions.

Quality check: a second function reviews scope decisions, evidence links, risk conclusions, and publication decisions before submission or republication, confirming that exhibits match the stated scope, dates are current, and open items are either closed or explicitly reviewed by counsel with written notes. Cycle 8 reinforces consistent file discipline, traceable decisions, and timely follow-up across suppliers, channels, and reviewers without adding new tools or changing assigned functions.

Operational drill, labeled illustrative: select one lot or one claim, run the full workbook path end to end with real file references, time each step, record friction points, and update the procedure with the fix before the next cycle. Keep the drill record with the lot or review file so progress is visible across weeks. Cycle 9 reinforces consistent file discipline, traceable decisions, and timely follow-up across suppliers, channels, and reviewers without adding new tools or changing assigned functions.

Documentation standard: write dates in year-month-day order, name files with identifiers first, cite exhibits by file name in every note, record reviewer function with each sign-off, and freeze submitted or

published rows before starting amendments as new rows that reference the original. Cycle 10 reinforces consistent file discipline, traceable decisions, and timely follow-up across suppliers, channels, and reviewers without adding new tools or changing assigned functions.

Escalation rule: any missing core evidence, any supplier non-response past the agreed date, any uncertain scope decision, and any high-risk score moves to the Gap Memo or Remediation Tracker the same day with a named owner and a due date, plus a counsel question where the facts are difficult. Cycle 11 reinforces consistent file discipline, traceable decisions, and timely follow-up across suppliers, channels, and reviewers without adding new tools or changing assigned functions.

Quality check: a second function reviews scope decisions, evidence links, risk conclusions, and publication decisions before submission or republication, confirming that exhibits match the stated scope, dates are current, and open items are either closed or explicitly reviewed by counsel with written notes. Cycle 12 reinforces consistent file discipline, traceable decisions, and timely follow-up across suppliers, channels, and reviewers without adding new tools or changing assigned functions.

Operational drill, labeled illustrative: select one lot or one claim, run the full workbook path end to end with real file references, time each step, record friction points, and update the procedure with the fix before the next cycle. Keep the drill record with the lot or review file so progress is visible across weeks. Cycle 13 reinforces consistent file discipline, traceable decisions, and timely follow-up across suppliers, channels, and reviewers without adding new tools or changing assigned functions.

Documentation standard: write dates in year-month-day order, name files with identifiers first, cite exhibits by file name in every note, record reviewer function with each sign-off, and freeze submitted or published rows before starting amendments as new rows that reference the original. Cycle 14 reinforces consistent file discipline, traceable decisions, and timely follow-up across suppliers, channels, and reviewers without adding new tools or changing assigned functions.

Escalation rule: any missing core evidence, any supplier non-response past the agreed date, any uncertain scope decision, and any high-risk score moves to the Gap Memo or Remediation Tracker the same day with a named owner and a due date, plus a counsel question where the facts are difficult. Cycle 15 reinforces consistent file discipline, traceable decisions, and timely follow-up across suppliers, channels, and reviewers without adding new tools or changing assigned functions.

Quality check: a second function reviews scope decisions, evidence links, risk conclusions, and publication decisions before submission or republication, confirming that exhibits match the stated scope, dates are current, and open items are either closed or explicitly reviewed by counsel with written notes. Cycle 16 reinforces consistent file discipline, traceable decisions, and timely follow-up across suppliers, channels, and reviewers without adding new tools or changing assigned functions.

Operational drill, labeled illustrative: select one lot or one claim, run the full workbook path end to end with real file references, time each step, record friction points, and update the procedure with the fix before the next cycle. Keep the drill record with the lot or review file so progress is visible across weeks. Cycle 17 reinforces consistent file discipline, traceable decisions, and timely follow-up across suppliers, channels, and reviewers without adding new tools or changing assigned functions.

Documentation standard: write dates in year-month-day order, name files with identifiers first, cite exhibits by file name in every note, record reviewer function with each sign-off, and freeze submitted or published rows before starting amendments as new rows that reference the original. Cycle 18 reinforces consistent file discipline, traceable decisions, and timely follow-up across suppliers,

channels, and reviewers without adding new tools or changing assigned functions.

Escalation rule: any missing core evidence, any supplier non-response past the agreed date, any uncertain scope decision, and any high-risk score moves to the Gap Memo or Remediation Tracker the same day with a named owner and a due date, plus a counsel question where the facts are difficult.

Cycle 19 reinforces consistent file discipline, traceable decisions, and timely follow-up across suppliers, channels, and reviewers without adding new tools or changing assigned functions.